

NGN NCSBN QUESTION BANK

DEVELOPMENT INSTRUCTIONS

4,000 Questions | 8 Question Types | 8 Concepts | CAT Format

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Prepared for: Question Development Team

Version 2.0 - Updated and Verified

SECTION 1: PROJECT OVERVIEW

This document provides complete instructions for developing 4,000 NGN (Next Generation NCLEX) questions for the NCSBN examination preparation system. The test follows the Computerized Adaptive Testing (CAT) format with 150 questions per test session.

IMPORTANT: Every single question MUST have all mandatory fields filled in. No field can be left blank. Each question must be tagged with its Topic AND Concept. All 8 question types must be represented. All numbers in this document have been verified to add up correctly.

Key Numbers at a Glance

Total questions to create: 4,000

Questions per test (CAT): 150

Question types: 8 different NGN formats

Concepts: 8 nursing concept categories

Topics: 36 clinical topics distributed across the 8 concepts

Difficulty split: Easy 20% | Moderate 50% | Hard 30%

SECTION 2: QUESTION TYPE DISTRIBUTION

The 4,000 questions are split across 8 NGN question types. Multiple Choice has the largest share because it remains the most common item type.

QUESTION TYPE	COUNT	% OF BANK
Multiple Choice (MC)	1,200	30%
SATA (Select All That Apply)	600	15%
MPR (Multiple Response)	480	12%
Dropdown (Cloze)	400	10%
MMR (Matrix Multiple Resp.)	400	10%
Drag and Drop	360	9%
Highlight	320	8%
Bowtie	240	6%
GRAND TOTAL	4,000	100%

SECTION 3: DIFFICULTY LEVEL DISTRIBUTION

Every concept and every clinical topic must contain questions across all three difficulty levels. The overall bank follows a 20-50-30 distribution to simulate the adaptive nature of the CAT exam.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL	PERCENTAGE	TOTAL QUESTIONS
Easy (Recall / Knowledge)	20%	800
Moderate (Application / Analysis)	50%	2,000
Hard (Synthesis / Evaluation)	30%	1,200
GRAND TOTAL	100%	4,000

Difficulty Breakdown per Concept

Each concept must follow the same 20/50/30 split internally.

CONCEPT	TOTAL	EASY (20%)	MODERATE (50%)	HARD (30%)
Adult Health	1,000	200	500	300
Critical Care	520	104	260	156
Child Health	480	96	240	144
Fundamentals	480	96	240	144
Maternal and Newborn Health	400	80	200	120
Mental Health	400	80	200	120
Leadership and Management	360	72	180	108
Pharmacology	360	72	180	108
TOTAL	4,000	800	2,000	1,200

SECTION 4: CONCEPT ALLOCATION (8 Concepts)

The 4,000 questions are distributed across 8 nursing concept categories. Higher-weighted concepts like Adult Health and Critical Care reflect their larger share on the actual NCLEX-RN exam.

CONCEPT CATEGORY	TOTAL Qs	% OF BANK	# TOPICS	Qs / TOPIC (~)
Adult Health	1,000	25%	9	111
Critical Care	520	13%	4	130
Child Health	480	12%	2	240
Fundamentals	480	12%	5	96
Maternal and Newborn Health	400	10%	5	80
Mental Health	400	10%	3	133
Leadership and Management	360	9%	5	72
Pharmacology	360	9%	3	120
GRAND TOTAL	4,000	100%	36	—

SECTION 5: TOPIC ASSIGNMENT (36 Topics → 8 Concepts)

Each of the 36 clinical topics belongs to exactly ONE concept. When tagging a question, the topic and concept must match this table.

IMPORTANT: Do not assign a topic to a different concept than what is listed below. Consistency is critical for the database filtering in phpMyAdmin.

CONCEPT	TOTAL Qs	# TOPICS	TOPICS UNDER THIS CONCEPT
Adult Health	1,000	9	Cardiovascular, Respiratory, Endocrine, Gastrointestinal, Genitourinary, Musculoskeletal, Integumentary, Hematology, Eyes/Ears/Nose/Throat
Critical Care	520	4	Emergency Care, Neurology, Immunology, Oncology
Child Health	480	2	Growth and Development, Communicable Disease
Fundamentals	480	5	Skills/Procedures, Communication, Pain Meds, Fluid and Electrolyte, Gastrointestinal/Nutrition
Maternal and Newborn Health	400	5	Antepartum, Intrapartum, Postpartum, Labor and Delivery, Neonatology
Mental Health	400	3	Psychiatry, End of Life Care, Culture and Religion
Leadership and Management	360	5	Assignment/Delegation, Management Concepts, Nursing Legalities, Leadership and Management, Prioritization
Pharmacology	360	3	Psych Meds, Psych Drugs, Maternal and Newborn Drugs
TOTAL	4,000	36	All 36 topics covered

SECTION 6: QUESTION TYPES AND REQUIRED FIELDS

Below are the 8 question types you need to create. For each type, every listed field is MANDATORY. Do not skip any field.

1. DROPDOWN (Cloze)

A passage with blank spaces where the student selects the correct answer from a dropdown menu for each blank.

FIELD NAME	DESCRIPTION / WHAT TO WRITE
concept	Nursing concept (one of the 8 concepts)
question	The stem/scenario with blanks
passage	Full clinical scenario or case passage
options	List of dropdown choices per blank (min 3 options each)
highlightable	Yes/No - if passage text can be highlighted
correct_words	Correct answer for each dropdown blank
rationale	Explanation of why each correct answer is right
system	Body system / concept category
cnc	Client Needs Category (e.g., Physiological Integrity)
dlevel	Easy / Moderate / Hard

2. MATRIX MULTIPLE RESPONSE (MMR)

A table where each row has checkboxes across columns. Students can check more than one box per row AND per column. RULE: Each column must have at least 1 selected. Each correct combination must be UNIQUE per question.

FIELD NAME	DESCRIPTION / WHAT TO WRITE
concept	Nursing concept
case_title	Title of the clinical case
topic	Specific topic
question	Question/instruction for the matrix
columns	Column headers (e.g., Effective, Ineffective, Unrelated)
rows	Row labels (e.g., list of nursing actions)
correct	Correct checkbox pattern (MUST be unique per question)
rationale	Explanation for correct/incorrect combinations
cnc	Client Needs Category
narcan	Subcategory tag (Opioid, Electrolytes, Fluid, etc.)
system	Body system

dlevel	Easy / Moderate / Hard
nurses_notes	Nurse documentation for the scenario
vital_signs	Patient vital signs
diagnostics	Lab results / diagnostic findings
screen_no	Screen number (multi-screen items)
total_screens	Total screens in item set

3. DRAG AND DROP

Students drag answer options from a bank and drop them into the correct position or category.

FIELD NAME	DESCRIPTION / WHAT TO WRITE
concept	Nursing concept
question	Question/instruction
items	List of draggable items
correct	Correct placement/order
rationale	Explanation for correct arrangement
system	Body system
cnc	Client Needs Category
narcn	Subcategory tag
dlevel	Easy / Moderate / Hard

4. MULTIPLE RESPONSE (MPR / Enhanced SATA)

Question with checkbox options. Students select ALL correct answers. The number of correct answers VARIES per question (2, 3, 4, etc.) based on the clinical scenario.

FIELD NAME	DESCRIPTION / WHAT TO WRITE
case_title	Title of the clinical case
topic	Specific topic
question	The question stem
choices	All answer options (with checkboxes)
correct_answer	All correct options (count varies per question)
rationale	Explanation for each correct AND incorrect choice
concept	Nursing concept
system	Body system
dlevel	Easy / Moderate / Hard

5. HIGHLIGHT

Students highlight specific words or phrases in a passage that answer the question. Each question has a **DIFFERENT** max highlight limit.

FIELD NAME	DESCRIPTION / WHAT TO WRITE
topic	Specific topic
question	Question/instruction
passage	Full text passage to read
options	Highlightable words/phrases in the passage
correct_words	Correct words/phrases to highlight
rationale	Explanation for correct highlights
system	Body system
cnc	Client Needs Category
narcan	Subcategory tag
dlevel	Easy / Moderate / Hard
max_highlight	Max highlights allowed (VARIES per question: 2, 3, 4, etc.)

6. BOWTIE

Complex clinical reasoning item shaped like a bowtie. Students identify the central action, potential conditions (left), and parameters to monitor (right). Includes 3 tabs.

FIELD NAME	DESCRIPTION / WHAT TO WRITE
question	The clinical scenario/stem
action_to_take	Priority nursing action (center of bowtie)
potential_conditions	Possible diagnoses (left side)
parameters_to_monitor	What to monitor (right side)
nurses_notes	Tab: Nurse documentation
vital_signs	Tab: Patient vital signs
diagnostics	Tab: Lab values / diagnostics

7. SATA (Select All That Apply)

Standard select-all-that-apply with checkbox options.

FIELD NAME	DESCRIPTION / WHAT TO WRITE
concept	Nursing concept
question	The question stem

items	List of answer choices (checkboxes)
correct_answer	All correct options
rationale	Explanation for each choice
system	Body system
cnc	Client Needs Category
narcan	Subcategory tag (Opioid, Electrolytes, Fluid, etc.)
dlevel	Easy / Moderate / Hard

8. MULTIPLE CHOICE (Single Best Answer)

Traditional single-answer multiple choice with 4 options.

FIELD NAME	DESCRIPTION / WHAT TO WRITE
concept	Nursing concept
question	The question stem
choices	4 answer options (A, B, C, D)
correct	The single correct answer
rationale	Explanation for correct + incorrect options
system	Body system
cnc	Client Needs Category
narcan	Subcategory tag
dlevel	Easy / Moderate / Hard

SECTION 7: SPECIAL RULES PER QUESTION TYPE

IMPORTANT: Read these rules carefully. These are the rules that make NGN questions different from traditional NCLEX questions.

MMR (Matrix Multiple Response) Rules

1. Students CAN check more than one box per row.
2. Students CAN check more than one box per column.
3. Each COLUMN must have at least 1 response selected in the correct answer.
4. The correct answer pattern must be UNIQUE per question (no two MMR questions should have the same checkbox pattern).

MPR (Multiple Response) Rules

1. The number of correct answers VARIES per question.
2. Some questions may have 2 correct answers, others may have 3, 4, or more.
3. The number depends entirely on the clinical scenario.
4. Do NOT make all questions have the same number of correct answers.

Highlight Rules

1. Each question has a max highlight limit (how many words can be highlighted).
2. This limit must VARY across questions (e.g., max 2, max 3, max 4).
3. Do NOT use the same max highlight number for every question.

Bowtie Rules

1. Left side: Potential conditions/diagnoses the patient may have.
2. Center: The priority nursing ACTION to take.
3. Right side: Parameters/assessments to MONITOR.
4. Must include all 3 tabs: Nurses Notes, Vital Signs, Diagnostics.

Dropdown (Cloze) Rules

1. Each blank in the passage must have at least 3 dropdown options.
2. Distractors must be plausible (not obviously wrong).
3. The passage must be a realistic clinical scenario.

SECTION 8: MANDATORY TAGGING PER QUESTION

Every question, regardless of type, MUST have these tags filled in:

TAG	OPTIONS / DESCRIPTION	REQUIRED?
concept	One of the 8 concepts (see Section 4)	YES - MANDATORY
topic	One of the 36 topics (see Section 5)	YES - MANDATORY
system	Same as concept (body system category)	YES - MANDATORY
cnc	Client Needs Category: Safe and Effective Care, Health Promotion, Psychosocial Integrity, Physiological Integrity	YES - MANDATORY
narcan	Subcategory tag (Opioid, Electrolytes, Fluid, Cardiac, etc.)	YES - MANDATORY
dlevel	Easy / Moderate / Hard	YES - MANDATORY
rationale	Full explanation of correct + incorrect answers	YES - MANDATORY
question	The question stem with clinical scenario	YES - MANDATORY

SECTION 9: YOUR ACTION STEPS

Follow these steps in order to complete the question bank:

STEP 1: Set up your workspace with separate sheets for each of the 8 question types.

Each sheet should have columns matching the required fields in Section 6.

STEP 2: Follow the distribution numbers in Sections 2, 3, and 4.

Make sure your totals match: 4,000 questions, 800 Easy, 2,000 Moderate, 1,200 Hard.

STEP 3: Tag every question with ALL mandatory fields from Section 8.

No field can be left blank. Double-check before submission.

STEP 4: Apply the 20/50/30 difficulty split within each concept.

Use the breakdown table in Section 3 as your reference.

STEP 5: Use the topic assignment in Section 5 strictly.

Each topic belongs to only ONE concept. Do not mix them up.

STEP 6: Quality check each question type against the special rules in Section 7.

Especially MMR uniqueness, MPR variable correct answers, and Highlight variable max limits.

STEP 7: Submit in batches of 500 for review.

This allows quality issues to be caught early before proceeding.

SECTION 10: FINAL REMINDERS

IMPORTANT: This is a CAT (Computerized Adaptive Testing) system. The questions must cover a wide range of difficulties so the algorithm can accurately assess each student. Do NOT cluster all hard questions in one topic or all easy questions in one concept.

IMPORTANT: Every question must have a RATIONALE. The rationale is what students learn from. It should explain WHY the correct answer is correct AND WHY each incorrect option is wrong.

IMPORTANT: For MMR questions: The correct checkbox pattern must be UNIQUE. Do not copy-paste the same matrix answer pattern across multiple MMR questions.

IMPORTANT: For Highlight questions: The max_highlight value must VARY. If you have 320 highlight questions, use a mix of max 2, max 3, max 4, and max 5 across them.

IMPORTANT: For MPR/SATA questions: The number of correct answers should vary naturally. If a clinical scenario has 3 correct nursing actions, the answer is 3. If another has 5, the answer is 5. Never force a fixed number.

IMPORTANT: All numbers in this document have been verified to add up to 4,000. If you find any inconsistency while working, stop and report it immediately.

END OF INSTRUCTIONS

For questions or clarifications, contact the project lead.